



Imagine a beetle, not just any beetle, but one of the largest, most impressive beetles in the world - the Hercules beetle! These incredible insects are famous for their size, which can reach up to 6.7 inches long, and their spectacular horn-like structures, which males use to battle each other. The Hercules beetle is shiny and can be green, gray, or brown, and it's known to change its color, almost like magic, depending on the light and the humidity. With their strong bodies, they can carry up to 850 times their own weight, making them one of the strongest creatures on earth.

Speaking of their strength, ever wondered what kind of meals fuel these mighty creatures? Hercules beetles are natural recyclers as they love munching on rotting wood and fruits for dinner. They play a very important role in the ecosystem by helping to break down and recycle dead plants. But remember, just like us, they need water to live, so they often live near streams or places where they can easily access water.

Now that we know what they eat and where they live, let's dive into their fascinating life cycle. Hercules beetles start their life as tiny eggs, which then hatch into larvae, the stage at which they do most of their growing. They then change into pupae, sort of like beetle teenagers, before finally becoming adult Hercules beetles. This entire process can take up to two years, which is quite long for an insect.



We've learned so much about these amazing beetles, but how do they interact with humans and other animals? In general, they are harmless to humans and prefer to avoid confrontation, using their impressive horns to defend themselves if necessary. They are often kept as pets due to their unique appearance and low maintenance, and have a peaceful relationship with other animals. So, next time you think of Hercules, don't just think of the strong hero from Greek mythology, but also remember the mighty Hercules beetle, one of the largest and strongest beetles in the world.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) How do Hercules beetles use their horns?
 - A. to dig burrows
 - B. to battle each other
 - C. to protect their eggs
 - D. to swim in water
- 2) Why are Hercules beetles called recyclers?
 - A. They help bees recycle nectar into honey
 - B. They collect and store food for the winter
 - C. They naturally sort plastic from organic waste
 - D. They break down and recycle dead plants
- 3) What do Hercules beetles eat?
 - A. nectar from flowers
 - B. rotting wood and fruits
 - C. grass and leaves
 - D. other insects
- 4) Why are Hercules beetles often kept as pets?
 - A. because they can perform tricks
 - B. because they are friendly and playful
 - C. due to their unique appearance and low maintenance
 - D. because they are rare and valuable
- 5) Are Hercules beetles harmful to humans?
 - A. No
 - B. Only males beetles
 - C. Only female beetles
 - D. Yes
- 6) What is the Hercules beetle famous for?
 - A. their ability to change color
 - B. their size and horn-like structures
 - C. their long lives
 - D. their great swimming ability
- 7) How do Hercules beetles help the ecosystem?
 - A. by breaking down and recycling dead plants
 - B. by providing food for other animals
 - C. by pollinating flowers
 - D. by creating underground burrows
- 8) Where would you most likely find a Hercules beetles living?
 - A. near a stream
 - B. At the top of a mountain
 - C. In an urban area
 - D. in the desert
- 9) Do Hercules beetles have a long or short life cycle compared to other insects?
 - A. Long
 - B. Short
 - C. Depends on the specific beetle
 - D. The same as other insects
- 10) How long does it take for a Hercules beetle to complete its life cycle?
 - A. up to two years
 - B. up to five years
 - C. up to one year
 - D. up to six months



Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I can lift 10,000 times my own weight."
- 12) "No one can match my strength. I can lift things 850 times heavier than my own body weight!"
- 13) "I start life as a tiny egg, then grow into a larva, that's when I do most of my growing!"
- 14) "I don't need fancy food. Give me rotting wood or fruits, that's my kind of meal!"
- 15) "I'm one of the biggest beetles you'll ever see. At almost 7 inches long, I'm longer than a dollar bill!"
- 16) "I am harmful to humans."
- 17) "I despise rotten food, it makes me sick."
- 18) "I play my part in keeping nature clean. I help break down and recycle dead plants."
- 19) "My transformation from a tiny egg to an adult happens in a few weeks."
- 20) "My life cycle is very short."
- 21) "I've got pretty amazing horns on my head! I use them to wrestle with other males."
- 22) "My horns are just for show, they serve no real purpose."
- 23) "I need water to live, so I like to be near streams or places where it's easy for me to find water."
- 24) "I'm usually peaceful and try and avoid conflicts. But if necessary, I will use my horns to defend myself."
- 25) "I'm always aggressive and ready to fight."
- 26) "I don't need much care. That's why many people keep me as a pet."
- 27) "From being an egg to growing into an adult, it takes me around two years!"
- 28) "I usually live in dry places where water isn't accessible."
- 29) "I don't need any water to live."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 30) Hercules beetles can live up to two years.
- 31) Hercules beetles are not at all scary, they are just unique-looking.
- 32) Hercules beetles are often found eating decaying wood and fruits.
- 33) I think it's amazing how Hercules beetles can change their color, almost like magic.
- 34) Hercules beetles can be among the largest beetles in the world, reaching lengths of over 6 inches.
- 35) The life cycle of Hercules beetles is fascinating, from eggs to larvae, to pupae, and finally into adult beetles.
- 36) Hercules beetles can usually be found near sources of water.
- 37) Hercules beetles can lift something that is 850 times heavier than themselves.
- 38) Having a Hercules beetle as a pet can be very interesting due to their unique appearance.
- 39) It's cool how Hercules beetles eat decaying plant matter and fruit.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 40) The life cycle of the Hercules beetle can take up to two years.
- 41) Hercules beetle larvae only eat rotting wood.
- 42) Adult Hercules beetles can carry up to 850 times their own weight.
- 43) The Hercules beetle is one of the smallest beetles in the world.
- 44) Hercules beetles may eat rotting wood.

- 45) Hercules beetles can carry up to 10,000 times their own weight.
- 46) Hercules beetles will attack humans if they come near.
- 47) Hercules beetles do not need water to live.
- 48) Hercules beetles are often kept as pets.
- 49) The Hercules beetle can change its color depending on the light and humidity.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 50) They don't bite or sting humans.
A. does not
B. do not
C. did not
D. will not
- 51) You won't believe how big they can grow.
A. will not
B. cannot
C. would not
D. do not
- 52) Hercules beetles can't fly very far.
A. can
B. are not able
C. will not
D. cannot
- 53) It's amazing how strong they are for their size.
A. it is
B. it was
C. it will
D. it has
- 54) They're known for their large horns.
A. they will
B. they were
C. they are
D. they do

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 55) Amazing isn't it, that the lifecycle of a Hercules beetle can last up to three years!
- 56) Be careful not to touch the hercules beetle's horns.
- 57) Are Hercules beetles dangerous to humans?
- 58) Can you believe Hercules beetles can lift up to 850 times their own body weight?
That's like a human lifting an elephant!
- 59) Hercules beetle larvae mostly eat rotten wood and leaf litter.
- 60) What is the purpose of the large horn on a male Hercules beetle?
- 61) Hercules beetles are harmless to humans and do not bite or sting.
- 62) What do Hercules beetle larvae eat?
- 63) Male Hercules beetles use their large horns to fight other beetles.
- 64) Observe the unique patterns on the exoskeleton of Hercules beetles.
- 65) Hercules beetles are one of the largest insects in the world!
- 66) Handle Hercules beetles with care.



Hercules Beetles

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Hercules Beetles

Name: _____

1.	B	26.	Would	51.	A
2.	D	27.	Would	52.	D
3.	B	28.	Not	53.	A
4.	C	29.	Not	54.	C
5.	A	30.	fact	55.	exclamatory
6.	B	31.	opinion	56.	imperative
7.	A	32.	fact	57.	interrogative
8.	A	33.	opinion	58.	exclamatory
9.	A	34.	fact	59.	declarative
10.	A	35.	opinion	60.	interrogative
11.	Not	36.	fact	61.	declarative
12.	Would	37.	fact	62.	interrogative
13.	Would	38.	opinion	63.	declarative
14.	Would	39.	opinion	64.	imperative
15.	Would	40.	true	65.	exclamatory
16.	Not	41.	false	66.	imperative
17.	Not	42.	true		
18.	Would	43.	false		
19.	Not	44.	true		
20.	Not	45.	false		
21.	Would	46.	false		
22.	Not	47.	false		
23.	Would	48.	true		
24.	Would	49.	true		
25.	Not	50.	B		